

Socially speaking

There's not a soul online who hasn't wondered about becoming popular on the Internet. Back in the '90s and the early years of the online phenomenon, popularity was about being a wise-crack on Yahoo chat rooms or IRC channels, or being someone you looked up to on forums. Now, the social world has become a lot more complex not only in real life but also from a digital perspective. People are online not just to engage in trade and commerce but also to connect with family, friends, like-minded individuals or groups, and follow their favourite brands. Companies, personalities, social causes. Everyone's voicing their opinions online and at stake is more than just a bunch of people listening and reciprocating.

On large scale social platforms like Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn and more, effectively building a reputation and carving out a unique identity isn't just about blind luck. It needs careful planning, timely execution of a well thought out strategy to create a one-of-a-kind user appeal in an online world filled with competing voices.

For such a job, the role of a social media manager becomes critical in our digital age. For better or worse, our online experiences are shaped by what we search through web pages and encounter through trusted social platforms. Social media managers are responsible for most of what we see and hear on non-personal social media profiles and groups. A lot rides on their acumen and ability to shape our reality, and it isn't only defined by business interests alone as much of the online world's slowly waking up to.

Through this issue of FastTrack, we want to introduce our readers to just what it takes for you to be a social media manager. It's ideal for anyone who always wanted to start their own or a company's Facebook page and more, but didn't. How does good content become great on a social platform, and how to market said content through ingenious ways? Through